

Tambus relation to food mirrors her relation to education. Food is a means to escape. We see this literally in the beginning when she is able to pay for her schooling by selling food. When her brother stole her corn, he was stealing her education and such her ability to control her destiny. She differs from Nyasha in that african food is authentic to her. Compared to Babamakurus family she was the only one who liked Sadza

*“I was very pleased to see the sadza when it came, although nobody else seemed to care for it. This was embarrassing. There were many things that were embarrassing about that meal: my place looked as though a small and angry child had been fed there; here I was with a spoon in my hand instead of a fork and now Maiguru was dishing sadza on to my plate, sadza that nobody else would eat”*

While Nyasha does not find any food authentic, Tambu does. However, she is embarrassed by this and so as Nyasha forces up food, Tambu forces down food. Contrasting Nyasha even more, Tambu takes food as means of control. She eats, even though she is as aware as anyone the weight it carries. In part Tambus ability to eat food and assimilate to the patriarchy is buoyed by her ability to create it. Tambu grew her own vegetables from the ground. She is free from the power that Babamukuru wields over Nyasha.